

WhatsApp Marketing Tool - V1

Beginner Functional Plan for Fresh Coders

Goal

Build a simple standalone tool that lets each buyer connect their own WhatsApp Business account and phone number, run marketing campaigns, receive customer messages, and reply from inside the tool.

1. What are we building?

The business should be able to: connect its WhatsApp number -> add customers -> create marketing messages -> send campaigns -> see delivery results -> receive customer replies -> reply from our tool.

2. Main Screens We Need

- WhatsApp Setup
- Contacts
- Templates
- Campaigns
- Campaign Results
- Inbox
- Unsubscribe Management

3. WhatsApp Setup

This screen connects the buyer's own WhatsApp Business account to our tool.

- **Meta Business Portfolio:** Represents the buyer's company on Meta.
- **WhatsApp Business Account:** The buyer's company WhatsApp setup.
- **Business phone number:** The WhatsApp number customers will see.
- **Phone Number ID:** Meta's internal identifier for that phone number.
- **WhatsApp Business Account ID:** Meta's internal identifier for the WhatsApp account.
- **Access Token:** A secret key that allows our software to communicate with Meta.

Example setup status

WhatsApp Number: +91 98765 43210

Business: ABC Clothing

Status: Connected

4. Contacts

The buyer adds customers who may receive messages.

Name	Phone	Marketing Permission
John	+91 98...	Yes
Ahmed	+91 97...	Yes
Rahul	+91 96...	No

- Add customers manually.
- Upload customers from a spreadsheet.
- Remove customers.
- Mark customers as unsubscribed.

Important rule

Only send marketing messages to customers who have agreed to receive them.

5. Message Templates

Marketing messages started by the business must use an approved message template.

Example template - Weekend Sale

Hi {{name}},
We have a 20% discount this weekend.
Visit our store today.

Template flow:

Create in our tool	Send to Meta	Pending review	Approved / Rejected
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Create in our tool -> Send to Meta -> Pending review -> Approved / Rejected

Rule

Only templates marked Approved should be available when creating a marketing campaign.

6. Campaigns

This is the main marketing feature. The buyer clicks Create Campaign and follows these steps:

1. Give the campaign a name - Example: Diwali Sale 2026

2. Select customers - Example: 2,450 customers selected

3. Select an approved template - Example: Diwali Discount

4. Fill changing values - Example: {{name}} and {{discount}}

5. Preview the final message - Check exactly what customers will receive

6. Send the campaign - Our tool asks Meta to send the messages from the buyer's WhatsApp number

Variable example

Template: Hi {{name}}, get {{discount}} off today.

For John: Hi John, get 20% off today.

7. Campaign Results

After sending, show clear results for the campaign.

Result	Example Count
Total	2,450
Sent	2,430
Delivered	2,380
Read	1,920
Failed	20

Beginner mental model

Our tool sends the message -> Meta delivers it -> Meta tells our tool what happened -> our campaign screen updates.

8. Inbox

The inbox should feel similar to WhatsApp Web: conversations on the left, selected conversation on the right.

Example conversation

John: Is this offer available tomorrow?

Business: Yes, it is available until Sunday.

John: Great, thanks.

- Show incoming customer messages.
- Open the full conversation.
- Allow the buyer to type and send a reply when normal replies are allowed.
- Keep the conversation history visible.

9. Replying to Customers

When a customer messages the business, a 24-hour normal reply period begins from the customer's latest message.

Within 24 hours

The business can reply using normal messages. No approved template is required.

After 24 hours

Normal replies should be blocked. Show a message such as: "Normal reply period expired. Select an approved template to contact this customer."

10. Unsubscribe Management

If a customer asks to stop receiving marketing messages, the business must stop sending marketing campaigns to that customer.

Example

Customer sends: STOP

Our tool changes: Marketing Permission = No

Result: Never include that customer in future marketing campaigns.

11. What Happens Behind the Scenes

Fresh coders only need to remember these three simple flows:

Sending a message

Our Tool	Meta	WhatsApp	Customer
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Our Tool -> Meta -> WhatsApp -> Customer

Receiving a message

Customer	WhatsApp	Meta	Our Tool	Inbox
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Customer -> WhatsApp -> Meta -> Our Tool -> Inbox

Delivery updates

Meta	Sent	Delivered	Read	Campaign Screen
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Meta -> Sent -> Delivered -> Read -> Campaign Screen

12. V1 Modules

Keep V1 focused on exactly these modules:

- WhatsApp Setup
- Contacts
- Templates
- Campaigns
- Campaign Results
- Inbox
- Reply to Customer
- Unsubscribe Management

V1 scope

This is enough for a real standalone WhatsApp marketing and customer messaging tool. Do not add software-as-a-service features yet.

13. One Decision Before the Actual Build

Because each buyer will use their own Meta account and WhatsApp number, choose one onboarding method:

Option A - Manual Setup	Option B - Self-Service Connection
You or your developer helps each buyer connect their Meta account when installing the standalone software.	The buyer clicks Connect WhatsApp, signs into Meta, selects their business and phone number, and our software connects it.

Next step

Choose Option A or Option B before defining the module-by-module build order for the fresh coders.

Reference

Functional rules in this plan are based on Meta's official WhatsApp Business Platform documentation and WhatsApp Business Messaging Policy.